

ing camera. Zoom is an attractive feature for many, but more is not always better. The Nokia 3250 comes with an impressive-sounding 20x zoom, but the fact is it requires a pair of very steady hands to shoot at anything above 4x without motion compensation. Further, this is digital rather than optical zoom, which means image quality rapidly degrades as the zoom increases.

The SE K550i is branded "CyberShot", which is the brand name of Sony's camera line-up. As you might expect, it has the best camera, and the auto-focus feature only serves to enhance the already good photo quality. The lens is protected by a sliding cover (it's the only phone with such lens protection). The W710i also gives good photo quality, followed by the Nokia 3250 and the MotoKRZR. The SE K550i is also the only camera in this range that comes with a flash.

## Multimedia

The most notable of multimedia features is the media control buttons that let you easily access music without having to navigate slowly through the menus to the media player. The SE Walkman phone W710i and the Nokia 5300 have rubber-coated, large media buttons—very comfortable.

MP3 was not the only music format supported; AAC, too, is supported by all the phones. The Nokia 3250 even supports other formats such as WMA. FM radio is common on all the phones.

## Extras

We didn't actually test battery life, and we'll state them as the manufacturer did. The Nokia 3250 has the lowest talk time of three hours, and the 6131 has the lowest standby time of 200 hours. The SE W710i has the highest talk time of 10 hours and a standby time of 350 hours. The Nokia phones probably drain the batteries faster because of their larger display sizes.

The MotoKRZR, Nokia 6131, and SE W710i

have external LCD displays that let you keep track of things such as time, missed calls, etc. Other features such as Organizer, Calendar, Alarm, etc. were standard fare with all the phones.

## Accessories

Premium phones come with premium accessories. The Nokia 3250 XpressMusic comes with a hands-free, which has media player controls in addition to the basic hands-free buttons. It also has in-ear type earphones, which effectively cut off surrounding sound (by passive noise reduction), and gives a more immersive music experience. To store music, photos, and videos, these mobiles (except for the Nokia 6131) come with memory cards. The MotoKRZR, Nokia 3250, and the SEs come with 512 MB cards, though you'll probably soon require a larger card. The SE K550i comes with a paltry 64 MB card, as good as nothing these days. The Nokia 3250's hands-free has a 3.5-mm stereo jack through which you can connect regular (better) earphones, while the Nokia 5300 is provided with a 3.5-mm stereo adapter.

## Performance Signal Reception

As we'd anticipated, the Nokia mobiles boasted of the best signal reception. While the Motorola and SE phones lost signal when we entered the basement of our building, the Nokias held on.

## Voice Clarity

Through the earpiece, voice clarity was not much of an issue with any of the phones, though in noisier environments, the MotoKRZR, Nokia 3250, and SE W710i will prove to be a better choice. The speaker-phones of the Nokia 3250 and SE W710i have the best audibility. The SE has

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**Nokia 5300**

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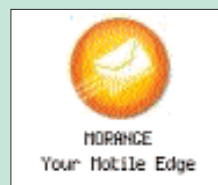
## Enhance your low budget mobile

**M**orange is a mobile application for J2ME-based phones. It can unleash new possibilities for a budget phone. Note that you require a working GPRS connection, and with that taken care of, you can enjoy the following features with Morange on your phone.

**Push Mail:** Morange retrieves mails from your e-mail accounts and "pushes" them to your mobile: your e-mails follow you wherever you go, and you'll never miss any. Generally, you can only get to know about new e-mails when you check for them, but with Push Mail, the mails are sent to your mobile as soon as they arrive on the mail server. Attachments are also supported, and you can send and receive mails using both POP3 and IMAP.

**Chat:** After you register for free on Morange.com, you can start chatting with contacts on Google Talk and MSN Messenger using your mobile. Yahoo! Messenger and ICQ will shortly be supported.

**Remote Desktop Access:** By installing the desktop client from Morange on your computer, you can remotely access your computer and browse the files and folders on it using



your mobile phone. You can also view document in formats such as Word, JPEG, text, and Excel.

You can transfer these files to the 5 MB of free space offered by Morange.com. Furthermore, you can even access your PC's Webcam.

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